

# Michael Kato

Technical Artist

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## Skills

**Languages:** Python, C#, C++, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS

**Engines:** Unity, CoD, Unreal, Source

**DCC & Graphics Tools:** Maya, Blender, Photoshop, RenderDoc, Perfetto

**Version Control & Infrastructure:** Perforce, Git, Mercurial

**Concepts:** VFX, Rigging, Animation, Shaders, Procedural Content, Performance Optimization, Automated Testing, Data Visualization, Deep Learning, LLM Integration

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## Experience

**Meta** | September 2020 - September 2023

*Senior Technical Artist (IC5) - Horizon Worlds (VR)*

- Improved VR platform performance for 300,000 monthly active users by embedding with a performance engineering team, implementing C# optimizations, extending Unity instrumentation, and resolved performance regressions in rendering, scripting, animation, and gameplay systems.
- Reduced regression risk by expanding automated performance testing with automated tests for rendering and gameplay performance, and per-commit A/B comparisons against a benchmark measurement.
- Increased engineering and leadership visibility into platform health by building SQL dashboards that surfaced live performance trends, hitch frequency, device-specific regressions, and automated test results.
- Profiled game builds using RenderDoc, Unity Profiler, and Perfetto to provide data-backed recommendations that helped artists and developers meet mobile VR performance budgets.

**Apple (Contract)** | April 2019 - August 2020

*Technical Artist - Synthetic Data for Apple Vision Pro*

- Increased artist production speed by automating LOD generation, asset validation, and thumbnail generation pipelines in Python across thousands of Maya scenes.
- Reduced manual production work by developing algorithms that generated procedural environments, validated metadata, and submitted render jobs overnight via Deadline.
- Streamlined outsourcing workflows by automating asset packaging, ingestion, QA validation, and Perforce integration, allowing external artists to work with the same tools and production standards as internal teams.
- Supported artists and other tech artists by developing more efficient tools, troubleshooting production issues, and maintaining reliable automation across the content pipeline.

## **Sledgehammer Games | January 2014 - May 2019**

*Technical Artist - Call of Duty: Advanced Warfare, WWII, Cold War*

- Led CPU and GPU performance optimization across singleplayer, zombies, and multiplayer modes, achieving consistent 60fps on all console platforms. Optimized everything from environments, materials, lighting, VFX, physics, animation, rigs, game script, etc.
- Eliminated thousands of hours of manual content creation by serving as the primary technical artist responsible for integrating and deploying an automated LOD generation pipeline used across nearly every environment, weapon, vehicle, and character asset in *Call of Duty: WWII*.
- Improved artist productivity by developing Python, MEL, JavaScript, C#, and C++ tools supporting Maya, Photoshop, Substance Painter, Perforce, exporters, rigging workflows, asset validation, and more.
- Supported more than 300 developers by troubleshooting technical art issues, debugging production pipelines, resolving build failures, and other help desk requests.
- Owned the destructible and dynamic prop authoring process across multiple titles, delivering hundreds of props that integrated VFX, audio, physics, collision, rigging, and scripting into grounded and fun in-game systems.
- Authored technical documentation, presented new workflows to technical artists across Activision studios, and established best practices that improved consistency across art departments.

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## **Education**

### **The Art Institute of Silicon Valley**

*BA in Game Art & Design: July 2009 - March 2013, Sunnyvale, CA*

### **[fast.ai](#)**

*Practical Deep Learning for Coders: March 2026 - Present*